

gets. The agent's name goes right to the top of the scoreboard posted in their office, otherwise known as the den of wolves.

The “Lyin’ Den”

There is a line from an old country song that goes something like: Mamas, don't let your babies grow up to be cowboys. Let me add to that: Mamas, don't let your babies grow up to be debt collection agency employees. These men, and women, are the henchmen of the consumer lending industry. There may not be a word in the dictionary for “henchwoman,” but they exist out there. These gals and guys are petty and ruthless and will stoop to any level to squeeze a dime out of you. I think they could eat rocks, and it would not upset their stomachs. There is not a colder breed of humans on the planet.

The tales of their duplicity are endless, and yet nothing is done to rein them in. It is no secret that some collection agencies break the law, yet day after day, their cruel tactics continue. If you are not to the point that you are dealing with collection agencies, good. Follow the advice given so far and you will stay out of their clutches. For those of you who are in the den of dragons, there is a way out.

Contrary to popular opinion, money is not the root of all evil; the love of money is. The greed, the ugly desire to grab the grub at all costs, is what ruins people. The resume of a debt collector would probably boast his or her top three qualities as being boldly unethical, taking pride in having questionable morals, and functioning as a specialist in harassment. Many people make the mistake of trying to reason with their debt collector. Many debt collectors are not reasonable people.

Fair Practices

As we've heard from our parents, our teachers, and our mentors, life is not always fair. We know that. The whole way that the credit card industry does business is not fair, but it is legal, so we march on. We citizens of good character don't have to revolt, exactly. Staging a Boston Tea Party type of demonstration where we all cut up our credit cards and toss them into the ocean, or the local cesspool, is not the solution.